

Ψευδο-Ἀρχύτας ὁ Πυθαγόρειος

Pseudo-Archytas the Pythagorean on the Ten Universal Categories

eul_aid: mxk

Period: Ἑλληνιστική Hellenistic

Dialect: Δωρική Doric

Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy

Format: Πραγματεία Treatise

Affiliation: Pythagorean

Pseudo-Archytas is the name given to an unknown author, or group of authors, from the Hellenistic period. They wrote philosophical works between the 1st century BCE and the 1st century CE, falsely attributing them to the famous early Pythagorean thinker, Archytas of Tarentum. This was a common practice at the time, used to give new ideas the authority of an ancient master.

The author wrote in the Doric dialect to mimic early Pythagorean style and produced a series of complete treatises. The most important is *On the Categories*, which reinterprets Aristotle's work from a Pythagorean and Platonic perspective. Other surviving works include *On Opposites*, *On the Intellect and Sensation*, and texts on ethics like *On Moral Education*.

According to modern scholars, the significance of these forgeries is historical. They were highly influential in late antiquity, as thinkers like Porphyry and Iamblichus believed them to be authentic. These texts helped create a narrative that Pythagorean philosophy was the original source for ideas found in Plato and Aristotle. The corpus is therefore a key example of philosophical syncretism, showing how Hellenistic thinkers blended different schools of thought to construct a unified tradition.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · *On the Ten Universal Categories* · 44 passages

Other Pythagorean Authors

- Ἀπολλόδωρος ὁ Κυζικηνός · *Apollodorus of Cyzicus* · 1 work
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Τυανεύς · *Apollonius of Tyana* · 3 works
- Ἀπολλώνιος ὁ Τυανεύς · *Apollonius of Tyana II* · 1 work
- Ἀρχύτας ὁ Ταραντίνος · *Archytas of Tarentum* · 2 works
- Ἀρέσας ὁ Λευκανός · *Aresas of Lucania* · 1 work
- Ἀθάμας ὁ Ποσειδωνιάτης · *Athamas of Posidonia* · 1 work
- Βροντίνος ὁ Μεταποντίνος · *Brontinus of Metapontum* · 2 works
- Κέρκωψ ὁ Ὀρφικός · *Cercops the Orphic* · 1 work
- Κλεινίας ὁ Ταραντίνος · *Clinias of Tarentum* · 2 works

- Δάμων καὶ Φιντίας · Damon and Phintias · 1 work
- Ἐχεκράτης ὁ Φλιάσιος · Echecrates of Phlius · 1 work
- Ἐκφάντος ὁ Πυθαγόρειος · Ecphantus the Pythagorean · 2 works